SEO ARCADE · SEO SOP

Audit Your Ad Accounts for Hidden Spend Leaks With AI

Source: Keith Perhac, SegMetrics (segmetrics.io / segmetrics.ai), on Unscripted SEO · "We had had three agencies work with us over like eight years. None of them ever saw this."

Objective

Every setting that sends ad spend somewhere you didn't choose found and switched off, every finding checked against the platform's own numbers, and an AI review on a schedule so the next leak is caught in days, not years. Keith's audit found $1,500 spent on mobile ads in a Mahjong game in the Philippines, plus an expanded-audience setting buried below the main ad.

Key Steps

1. **Find the number that can't be true** for a business your size. Keith's: ~300,000 retargeting clicks in a week - "HubSpot-level people."
2. **Write down the decision** the audit should support - "what is the decision you're gonna make from it?"
3. **Connect an AI to the ad platforms and your conversion data** (Keith: Claude via SegMetrics, connected to every ad platform). Read access first. *(inferred staging)*
4. **Ask why, below the campaign level.** "Just go figure out why." Check placements, audience expansion, ad group and ad settings - "settings deeper down that were overriding it."
5. **Make it show its numbers.** "Trust, but verify." Match each finding to the ad platform's own figure before changing anything.
6. **Turn off the leaks** - exclude placements, switch off expansion settings, log each fix. *(change log inferred)*
7. **Run the same audit on every ad platform.** "Now we're running all of them through Claude."
8. **Keep a review cadence.** AI analyses, recommends, changes, double-checks; a human reviews ~3x a week and pushes back.

Cautionary Notes

- Good-looking weekly reports aren't proof - the leak hid inside them.
- Confirm fatigue: read each change before approving it.
- Scope permissions: keep budget changes and new campaigns behind your approval.
- Not an agency-blame tool - "just one ad platform is so complex."
- One account's numbers; no before/after cost per lead was shared.

Tips for Efficiency

- Let it ask the follow-up questions (industry, audience segment).
- Run it in the background - "not faster, but it is doing it without me."
- Judge the fix by first touch and last touch.
- Review rebuilt creative on one contact sheet.

Full interview: unscriptedseo.com/keith-perhac-segmetrics-attribution-ai/ · Read online: seoarcade.com/seo-sop-audit-ad-accounts-for-hidden-spend-leaks/